

*Master Bogumił's workshop is all heat and haste — feast-orders for the great houses due by morning, the oven roaring in the back. The baker himself you do not see; he has not the moment to spare. But the jars are set out waiting on the bench, and wedged among them, in a hand dusted with flour, a note dashed off for whoever he could trust to come.*

Friends — forgive the scrawl, I've no hour to spare. A fool of an apprentice wiped my labels and set the lids back wrong, and I'll not heat the oven on a guess: one wrong root sours the whole batch. You've keen senses and you're from here, so you'll know them — cinnamon, cloves, ginger and cardamom, by their scent alone. Take their measure however you can, only do not open them, for a spice once aired is spoiled. And hold to my rule: it names every root and meal a piernik takes — but not all of them stand here on the bench tonight, so you'll have more names than jars. Set each jar to its name, and let the rest be.

And one thing more, while I've the quill. Big orders tonight, while the great men feast and nurse their grievance with the castle. Let it come to war — and it will — and see who pays. The lords keep their walls and their tolls; I lose my custom, the honey doubles, the roads close on my spice. A rising of rich men, and bakers and fishwives foot the bill. Rich stay rich, poor stay poor, and I'm the last sober head in a town gone to dancing.

— Master Bogumił

*You carry letters tonight for the very men he means – a rising of rich men, he calls it, and you are its hands. There is no one here to say it to, and no one to tell you he is wrong. The doubt sits in you like a stone: whose cause is this, and are they the ones in the right? You set the note down and take up the first jar.*

*Seven jars, and no two alike – if your senses are keen enough to part them. Trust what they tell you, and set the right name to each letter on his card. His recipe names every ingredient a *PIERNIK* takes; only some of them stand here in the jars before you, so a few names will have no jar at all – the recipe is your guide to what to expect.*

↪ GAME MASTER – Bring the filled card to the Game Master, who keeps to the Rynek Staromiejski (the Old Town market square). If the pierniki come out right, you'll have your pay – and a sealed letter telling you what to do next.